



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You washed your hands with soap and warm water before helping make a sandwich. You also wiped the kitchen counter with a clean cloth before placing the bread down.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You found some jam in the fridge with fuzzy mold growing on the top. You cut off the fuzzy-looking part and thought it was okay to eat the rest.**

## FOOD SAFETY

Kids (under 10)

FS-K03



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You left some potato salad out on the kitchen table for a while during a family party. You wonder if it's okay to eat it now.**

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You just washed your hands with soap and water for 20 seconds before making a peanut butter sandwich. You also wiped down the countertop with a clean cloth. Is this safe to eat?**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A hot dog was left out on the picnic table at a summer party for 3 hours in 85°F weather before people ate it. Is it safe to eat?**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Your family found a jar of homemade pickles in the pantry that's been opened and left out at room temperature for a few days. Is it safe to eat?**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You packed a picnic with cooked chicken, potato salad, and fresh fruit. You kept the cooler closed and in the shade with plenty of ice packs. You served and ate all the food within two hours.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A hamburger cooked on a barbecue was left out on the kitchen counter for 5 hours before being eaten.**





### IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to freeze fresh vegetables for future use. You blanched them briefly in boiling water, then froze them immediately. However, the power went out overnight and the vegetables thawed partially before the power returned.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You pack a cooler with freshly cooked chicken, keep it chilled below 40°F with ice packs during a summer picnic, and consume all leftovers within 2 hours of serving.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You find a can of home-canned green beans with a bulging lid and a foul odor inside the jar after storage at room temperature for several months.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You plan to can tomato salsa at home without adding lemon juice or citric acid, using a boiling water bath canner at your local altitude of 4000 feet.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You helped Mom wash fresh peaches and packed them tightly in clean jars. After adding the right amount of syrup and sealing the jars with new lids, you boiled them in a water bath canner just like the recipe said.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You found a jar of strawberry jam that had a fuzzy, green mold growing on top. The jar lid was still sealed tight, but the jam looked funny.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You canned peaches but left a jar on the kitchen counter overnight before putting it in the boiling water bath canner. The lid didn't pop down after cooking. Is it safe to eat?**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Maya carefully selects fresh, firm peaches and follows the exact tested recipe to can them in a boiling water canner. She uses new lids, fills the jars with boiling hot fruit, and processes them for the correct time. After cooling, she checks that the lids have sealed tightly before storing them in her cool pantry.**





## IS THIS SAFE?

**Jake puts fresh strawberries into jars but uses old, dented lids he found in the cupboard from last year. He processes the jars in boiling water for less time than the recipe says. After cooling, some jars do not seal properly, but Jake decides to store them anyway.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Leah canned Asian pears using a boiling water canner but forgot to add lemon juice to the jars before processing. She isn't sure if the pears will be safe to store at room temperature or if she should keep them in the refrigerator.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You prepare fresh peaches for canning by selecting firm, ripe fruit, washing them thoroughly, and peeling. You follow the exact recommended processing time using a boiling water canner, leaving the right headspace in sterilized jars. After processing, you cool the jars at room temperature without retightening the bands and store the sealed jars in a dark, cool place.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You filled jars with mixed fresh fruits and sealed them but didn't add any lemon juice or acid. You process the jars for less than 10 minutes in boiling water and did not adjust processing time for your altitude. You also overfilled the jars with fruit, leaving less than the recommended headspace.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to can slices of Asian pears at home. The recipe doesn't clearly say whether lemon juice is needed. You decide to can them in a boiling water canner, but you are unsure if you should add acid, process longer, or use a pressure canner instead.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You have selected fresh, firm peaches and prepared them according to a tested recipe by washing, peeling, and slicing. You packed them into clean, hot Mason jars with the recommended headspace and processed them in a boiling water canner for the exact time specified in the recipe, adjusting for your altitude.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You decided to can underripe plums without adding any acid or adjusting the boiling water canner processing time. You packed the fruit raw into jars without preheating or hot packing and processed them for less time than recommended in your source recipe.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to can pear halves at 3,000 feet altitude. The recipe you found shows times for sea level but lacks altitude processing time adjustments. You prepare the jars and pears as directed but are unsure if processing at sea level times is enough.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)





## IS THIS SAFE?

**You have a jar of salsa that you made following a recipe from your cooking book. You used ripe tomatoes, bottled lemon juice, and cooked the salsa in a boiling water canner for the recommended time.**

# CANNING TOMATOES & SALSAS

Kids (under 10)



CT-K02

## IS THIS SAFE?

**You found a jar of canned tomatoes in the pantry that has a lid popped up and you smell a strange, bad odor coming from inside the jar.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You made salsa using a new recipe, but you weren't sure if the amount of vinegar was just right. After canning it, you wonder if it's safe to eat.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You follow a tested recipe for tomato salsa, add the recommended amount of lemon juice, and process the jars in a boiling water canner for the full time. After canning, the jars seal tightly and you store them in a cool, dark place.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A family canned whole tomatoes that were very soft and from frost-killed vines, then packed them in jars without adding any lemon juice or citric acid before boiling water canning.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**After canning tomato salsa, the family finds one jar didn't seal. They're wondering if it's still safe to eat if they keep it in the refrigerator and use it soon.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Jamie used fresh, high-quality Roma tomatoes, peeled and cored them, then added bottled lemon juice before canning the salsa using a boiling water canner for the time recommended in a tested recipe.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Alex canned homemade salsa but reduced the amount of vinegar in the recipe by half and added fresh garlic and fresh herbs before processing in a boiling water canner.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)





## IS THIS SAFE?

**Taylor wants to make a salsa with tomatoes and add extra corn and black beans before canning in a boiling water bath. They wonder if it will be safe to do so.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You followed a tested salsa recipe that included adding bottled lemon juice to your tomatoes and onions, processed the jars in a boiling water canner for the full 15 minutes at your local altitude, and used fresh, firm Roma tomatoes.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You canned salsa using fresh tomatoes but did not add any bottled lemon juice or vinegar, and processed the jars in a boiling water canner for only 5 minutes instead of the recommended 15.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You made salsa with fresh garden tomatoes and peppers using your own original recipe that does not specify vinegar or bottled lemon juice amounts, then processed it in a boiling water canner for 15 minutes at sea level.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

## LOW ACID FOODS

Kids (under 10)

LA-K01



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Mom packed cooked green beans into jars and processed them in a pressure canner for the right time. The lid sealed tight, and the jars are cool now. Can we eat them safely from the jar?**

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

## LOW ACID FOODS

Kids (under 10)

LA-K02



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You find a jar of canned green beans in the pantry, but the lid popped up like a little mountain before you opened it. Is it safe to eat?**

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

## LOW ACID FOODS

Kids (under 10)

LA-K03



### IS THIS SAFE?

**A jar of cooked carrots was left out on the counter all day after canning. The lid sealed tight, but it smells a little funny. Is it safe to eat?**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Jamie canned fresh green beans in jars using a pressure canner following the exact time and pressure instructions from a trusted recipe. The jars sealed properly and were stored in a cool, dark pantry.**





### IS THIS SAFE?

**Alex canned leftover cooked meat in jars but used a boiling water bath canner instead of a pressure canner. The jars sealed and look fine, but Alex wants to eat the meat soon.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Morgan made homemade garlic oil and stored it in the fridge, but wonders if it's safe to keep it for up to a month. The oil covers the garlic completely and it's refrigerated constantly.**

## LOW ACID FOODS

Teens (14-18)

LA-T01



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to can green beans, which are low-acid vegetables. You follow a tested recipe precisely, use a pressure canner, maintain the correct pressure and time, and check your dial gauge annually.**

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You canned cooked potatoes in a boiling water bath canner instead of a pressure canner and stored the jars at room temperature.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You canned a mixture of meat and vegetables in a pressure canner but shortened the recommended processing time by 5 minutes to save time.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Sarah uses a tested USDA recipe to pressure can green beans in quart jars. She maintains correct headspace, adjusts processing time for her 3,000 feet altitude, and ensures her pressure canner's gauge is accurate before starting.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Tom fills quart jars with leftover spaghetti sauce with meat, puts on lids, and processes them in a boiling water canner for 20 minutes, then stores them at room temperature without refrigeration.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Linda stores homemade garlic-in-oil mixtures at room temperature, but she only followed some acidification steps and is unsure if the product is sufficiently acidified to prevent botulism.**



## PICKLING

Kids (under 10)

PK-K01



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You are making quick pickles by adding vinegar to your cucumbers using a clean jar and fresh ingredients. You use regular vinegar from the store with the right sour taste and keep the jar closed in the fridge.**

Sort it: SAFE · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS

# PICKLING

Kids (under 10)

PK-K02



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You find a jar of homemade pickles on the counter that was left open for a whole day, and the lid is popped up. The pickles look cloudy and smell funny.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

# PICKLING

Kids (under 10)

PK-K03



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Your pickles have been sitting on the counter at room temperature for a few days without being covered tightly. You notice a slight bubbly sound and the jar lid moved just a little.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

## PICKLING

Tweens (10-14)

PK-W01



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to make quick pickles by adding vinegar to sliced cucumbers. You use white distilled vinegar with 5% acidity and follow the recipe without changing the amount of vinegar. You keep the pickles refrigerated after sealing the jar.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

## PICKLING

Tweens (10-14)

PK-W02



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Someone soaked cucumbers in lime purchased from a garden center to make pickles. They forgot to rinse the cucumbers after soaking and then packed them in jars to pickle.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

## PICKLING

Tweens (10-14)

PK-W03



### IS THIS SAFE?

**After making fermented pickles in a crock, you left the vegetables uncovered at room temperature for a week. Now there are some bubbles and a bit of mold on the surface.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

# PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T01



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A teenager follows a tested recipe for refrigerator pickles using vinegar with 5% acidity, fresh cucumbers, and sterilized jars. They keep the pickles refrigerated and consume them within 2 weeks.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

## PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T02



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Someone tries to make pickles using homemade vinegar without knowing its acidity level and skips processing the jars in boiling water. They store the jars at room temperature for months.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



# PICKLING

Teens (14-18)

PK-T03



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A teen is making fermented pickles by following a traditional fermentation method but wonders if they have to add enough salt and keep the fermentation environment clean to ensure safety.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

# PICKLING

Adults

PK-A01



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A home cook follows a tested pickling recipe exactly, using 5% vinegar, packing vegetables in clean Mason jars with proper headspace, and processing in a boiling water canner for the recommended time based on altitude.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

# PICKLING

Adults

PK-A02



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Someone uses homemade vinegar of uncertain acidity to make pickles and does not adjust the recipe's vinegar amount or processing time. The jars are sealed without being processed in boiling water or a pressure canner.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)

# PICKLING

Adults

PK-A03



## IS THIS SAFE?

**A home preserver intends to make quick pickles but is unsure whether they should boil the jars in a water bath after packing with vinegar and vegetables stored at 4,000 feet elevation.**

Sort it: [SAFE](#) · [NOT SAFE](#) · [IT DEPENDS](#)



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Your mom made strawberry jam and boiled the jars in hot water for the right time. The jar lid is popped down tight, and the jam smells sweet and fresh. You can see no fuzzy stuff or bubbles in the jar.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You open a jar of your sweet grape jelly and see fuzzy green spots on top. The jelly smells weird and sour, not like the yummy jelly you remember. The lid was popped up when you tried to press it.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Your grandma left homemade peach jam out on the kitchen counter all day. When you check, the jam looks normal and smells okay, but the lid is not popped down tight. You wonder if it is safe to eat.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Emma followed a tested recipe to make strawberry jam, added the right amount of sugar and lemon juice, boiled it for the full time, then sealed the jars in a boiling water canner. She stored the jam jars in a cool, dark cupboard.**





## IS THIS SAFE?

**Liam made jam but used less lemon juice than the recipe called for and didn't heat the jam long enough. He canned it and stored it at room temperature hoping it would last.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Sophia made freezer jam using fresh raspberries and less sugar than usual. She stored the jars in the freezer but left one jar in the fridge for a week instead.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You made a strawberry freezer jam using a tested recipe from a low-sugar pectin package and stored it in the freezer right after sealing the jars. You keep the freezer jam frozen until you use it.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You canned a batch of peach jam but skipped the boiling water bath processing step and just let the hot jam cool in jars. You plan to store it on your pantry shelf for several months.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You want to make a jelly using elderberries you picked yourself. You know there are different varieties with different acidity levels, but you're not sure if yours is safe for standard canning.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You follow a tested low-sugar jam recipe that uses low-methoxyl pectin. After cooking, you process the jars in a boiling water bath canner for 10 minutes. You refrigerate the jam after opening.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You opened a jar of jelly stored at room temperature and noticed a fuzzy mold growth on the surface. You carefully scraped off the mold and planned to eat the jelly as usual.**

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You made a pepper jelly using a recipe without specifying added acid. You processed the jelly in a boiling water bath canner for the usual recommended time. You wonder if it's safe to store at room temperature.**





### IS THIS SAFE?

**You put your blueberries in the freezer right after picking them and keep the freezer cold all the time. When you want a snack, you take some out still frozen. Is this safe?**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Your friend left a bottle of canned soup in the unheated garage all winter and it froze. When she brought it inside, the can looks swollen and the lid is bulging. Is it safe to eat?**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You found a jar of homemade jam in the freezer, but the lid popped up a little. The jam still smells sweet and looks okay. Is this safe to eat?**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You froze cooked stew right after it cooled down by placing the pot in an ice-water bath and then put it in the freezer. You stored it at 0°F (-18°C) all along until you used it months later.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You found a can of canned beans in your unheated garage that froze over the winter. The can is bulging and the lid looks like it might be broken.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You thawed frozen meat in the fridge, but it sat there for 3 days before you cooked it.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You freshly cook a batch of vegetable soup and cool it quickly by placing the pot in an ice-water bath, stirring often. Then, you pack the cooled soup into freezer-safe containers, leaving some headspace, and freeze it right away at 0°F (-18°C).**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You place raw ground meat directly into the freezer without packaging or chilling it first, then find it frozen solid days later. Before cooking, you thaw it on the kitchen counter overnight at room temperature.**





## IS THIS SAFE?

**You froze some leftover cooked rice in a shallow container but left it in the fridge overnight before freezing it. Sometimes you put frozen veggies in the fridge a bit before cooking, but other times you cook them right from the freezer.**

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Marcy freezes a batch of homemade vegetable soup immediately after cooking, cooling it quickly in an ice bath before portioning and placing it in airtight containers in her freezer held at 0°F (-18°C). She always labels the containers with the date and plans to use them within 3 months.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Tom stores canned vegetables in his unheated garage over winter where temperatures drop below 30°F. He notices some cans have bulging lids but thaws them and uses the contents without further inspection or heating.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**Lena thawed frozen green beans that had partially warmed to 45°F during a power outage. She wonders if she can safely refreeze or cook them.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You helped your family dry apples by cutting them into thin slices and watching them in the dehydrator until they were dry and leathery. Now the apple slices are stored in a clean, airtight container on the kitchen shelf.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You smoked some fish outside, but when you opened the smokehouse later, the fish smelled strong and funny, and the outside was sticky and slimy.**

## DEHYDRATING & SMOKING

Kids (under 10)

DS-K03



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You left beef jerky out on the kitchen counter all day after drying it. It looks dry but smells a little different than when you first made it.**

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Maria dried apple slices using a home dehydrator. She made sure the apples were fully dried and stored them in an airtight container in a cool, dark place.**





### IS THIS SAFE?

**James smoked fish in a small metal smoker for 2 hours but did not finish cooking the fish in the oven afterward.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**Alex made beef jerky using a home dehydrator but did not heat the meat before drying. He wondered if the jerky was safe to eat.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**I use an electric dehydrator with a built-in thermostat set to 155°F to dry beef strips for jerky. After drying, I immediately check the temperature and confirm it reached at least 160°F for safety before storing.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**I smoke fish at home by hanging it outside in an unheated, smoky area without controlling the temperature or time, just guessing when it looks 'done.'**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**I'm drying slices of garden tomatoes which are acidic, but I'm not sure how long to dry them or if I need to heat them before storage.**



## IS THIS SAFE?

**You use a food dehydrator that maintains a steady temperature of 145°F to dry beef jerky. You always check the internal temperature of the dehydrator with an accurate thermometer before starting, ensuring it reaches the required temperature.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You smoke fish at home but do not monitor the temperature or time during the smoking process. You finish when the fish looks dried without measuring internal temperature or following any tested recipe.**



### IS THIS SAFE?

**You are drying tomatoes using a homemade solar dryer on your covered porch. You are unsure if the air temperature consistently reaches the recommended drying temperature and you don't know the altitude of your location.**